



Senior Data Analyst - Case Study

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- Duration:
- Max. 2 hours
- Format:
- Your choice. Slides, structured notes, bullet points, or prose - choose the format that helps you communicate clearly and efficiently.
- Purpose:
- Evaluate your analytical thinking, stakeholder empathy, and experience driving impact with data.
- Background:
- You've just joined [Unternehmen] as a Senior Data Analyst, responsible for stakeholder facing analytics. [Unternehmen] is scaling - across farmers, food companies, and internal operations.
- Our goal: make regenerative agriculture the default.
- Your team supports data strategy and insights across the org. We're now focusing on transforming our Sales team (focused on food company partnerships) into a truly data-driven, insight-empowered function.
- Until now, they've relied on unstructured Excel reports, fragmented CRM entries, and anecdotal win/loss insights.

Part 1: Making Sales Data-Driven task



- You've just joined the company as a Senior Data Analyst. The Sales team (focused on B2B food companies) has limited reporting, mostly Excel and CRM exports. The Head of Sales says: "We need to become data-driven. Right now, I don't trust the numbers, and I don't know what to focus on."
- Your task:
- Outline how you'd approach enabling the Sales team with actionable, trustworthy insights.
- We're especially interested in:
- What would be your first few steps?
- How would you win trust and adoption?
- Any hard-earned lessons from similar past work?

Part 1: Making Sales Data-Driven

Steps to become data driven



„We need to become data-driven. Right now, I don't trust the numbers, and I don't know what to focus on.”



🔍 Step 1: Understand current situation, needs

- Analyze / audit current Excel, CRM reports,...
- Meetings with sales representatives

Goals:

- get to know what is already used, what sources are available, which reports are duplicates
- Identify and document main KPIs and lean (main) sales processes

✓ Step 2: Fix Foundation

- Data quality review (Numbers in current reports valid? If not: entries in source systems correct?)
- Clean data and ensure correct input in future via employee training
- Create one database view / excel file with most relevant KPI to build up on

Goals:

- Build a trustworthy foundation
- Establish one version of truth

Part 1: Making Sales Data-Driven

Steps to become data-driven



Step 3: Build Dashboards

- Create simple interactive dashboard
 - based on version of truth
 - Uses current reporting tool (probably excel)
 - shows main KPIs / answers main Sales questions

Goals:

- Show value of data
- Early wins from working with data even before full report system established

Step 4: Team Usage

- Walkthrough of dashboard for all sales members
- Make dashboard part of referring sales weekly

Goals:

- Feedback on dashboard – what's missing / confusing
- Make data driven discussions / decisions a habit

Step 5: Scale Up

- Integrate sales sources in data warehouse
- Move from excel reports to BI tool
- Add (self service) reports for further sales questions

Goals:

- Level up
- Increase use of data

Part 1: Making Sales Data-Driven

Lessons learned



- ❖ Different point of views lead to different data
 - ⇒ make sure there is aligned understanding of KPIs and one single truth of data
- ❖ People won't use data they don't understand
 - ⇒ create self-explaining dashboards, give introductions / walkthroughs, be available for questions
- ❖ Trust in / understanding of data is key for adaption
 - ⇒ Make sure data is trustworthy and be open about limits, hick-ups
- ❖ The first attempt is almost never the last
 - ⇒ needs, questions, wishes for changes come with the usage of data. Rather send out 80% perfect reports with clear communication then don't send out anything at all.



Part 2: “The Data Is Wrong”

task



You deliver your first dashboards. The feedback from your stakeholders: “These numbers are wrong. This doesn’t match our Excel tracker.”

This is a pivotal moment. Based on your experience:

- What could be driving this reaction?
- What would you do short term?
- How would you solve the root causes long term?

Part 2: “The Data Is Wrong”

Reasons



„Real mistakes“

- Mistake in data pulling in new report
- Mistake in data pulling in old report

Hidden data background

- Using different data sources
- Different times for updating / refreshing the data

Mismatch in understanding

- Different calculation in reports
- Different definition of metrics
- Comparing different metrics

Expectations

- Sometimes it's just not what is expected, new reports feel wrong

Part 2: “The Data Is Wrong”

Short-Term Response: Restore Trust Through Transparency



❖ Stay calm and take doubts serious

❖ Schedule a meeting to look at it together:

- Find a common understanding in how to read the reports, the data logic
- Compare data sources, definitions, expectations
- Either adjust if necessary or write down limitations, definitions, differences in reading the reports

Part 2: “The Data Is Wrong”

How to fix it – long term



„Real mistakes“

- Dual control principle for main data pipelines
- Ensure clean data input, standards / automatic data validation at data entry

Hidden data background

- Create single source of truth (pre-calculated metrics etc.) as base for all reports

Mismatch in understanding

- Central (company wide) definition of metrics and data logic

Expectations

- Involve stakeholders at begin of report creation
- Onboarding sessions to data topics

★ Part 3: Real Impact

Task



- Tell us about a past project you're genuinely proud of. Ideally one where:
- You made a measurable impact with data
- The work was messy or ambiguous
- You had to collaborate with skeptical or non-technical stakeholders
- And now, looking back:
- Would you do anything differently?
- What key lessons would you bring to the company?

★ Part 3: Real Impact

Making complaints countable - Context



Background:

The company took over billing as a service. Within the company there was also a team handling the complaints of clients regarding these bills.

The team was working in an old software which didn't have a configurable reporting engine. So they were working with filter overviews within the software and self set up excel sheets.

The company itself had a more traditional mindset and was far beyond modern digitalization standards. When I started the company started a project to develop a new software that will replace the old one.

Goal:

It was my responsibility to set up a proper reporting system.

Challenges:

- No trustworthy historic data
- No definition of processes, reports, KPIs
- Company culture not data-driven, limited knowledge about how to use data
- Data scheme and data storage not set yet

★ Part 3: Real Impact

Making complaints countable – Approach



Understand the processes

I set up meetings and side by side work to get to know their way of working. As one result I draw a simplified process flow with crucial action points.

Define the goal

I guided through multiple workshops with head of and team leads where we were discussing the process and identified the relevant measures for each person / use case. Together we agreed on naming and definitions of the new KPIs. I also gathered the requirements for different reports (measure productivity, analyze complaint causes, estimate negative effect on company revenue,...)

Translate into technical requirements

Given the new KPI definitions I translated it into tracking points within the new software and made sure relevant data was collected and transferred to the single point of truth. Besides tracking points I also defined connections to other data sources and of primary keys.

First MVP

Based on the raw data I build a first dashboard in Metabase. So the team could use it for first insights and team management.

Translate into new reporting environment

tbd – I left before final Data warehouse was finished



★ Part 3: Real Impact

Making complaints countable – Takeaways



Results:

- Clear definition of company-wide KPIs
- Reliable insights on costs and causes of billing mistakes

Key learnings – what would I change

- ❖ Data pipelines changed during the creation
 - ⇒ documentation of goal of transformations is mandatory
- ❖ Despite the meeting where we agreed on the definition of metrics there were still various interpretation of the KPIs
 - ⇒ Documentation of the main info at a central place where everyone has access and look it up

Key learnings – what would I keep

- ❖ Cooperative decisions in workshops over theoretical suggestions
- ❖ Empathy, curiosity and service approach when it comes to communication with stakeholders